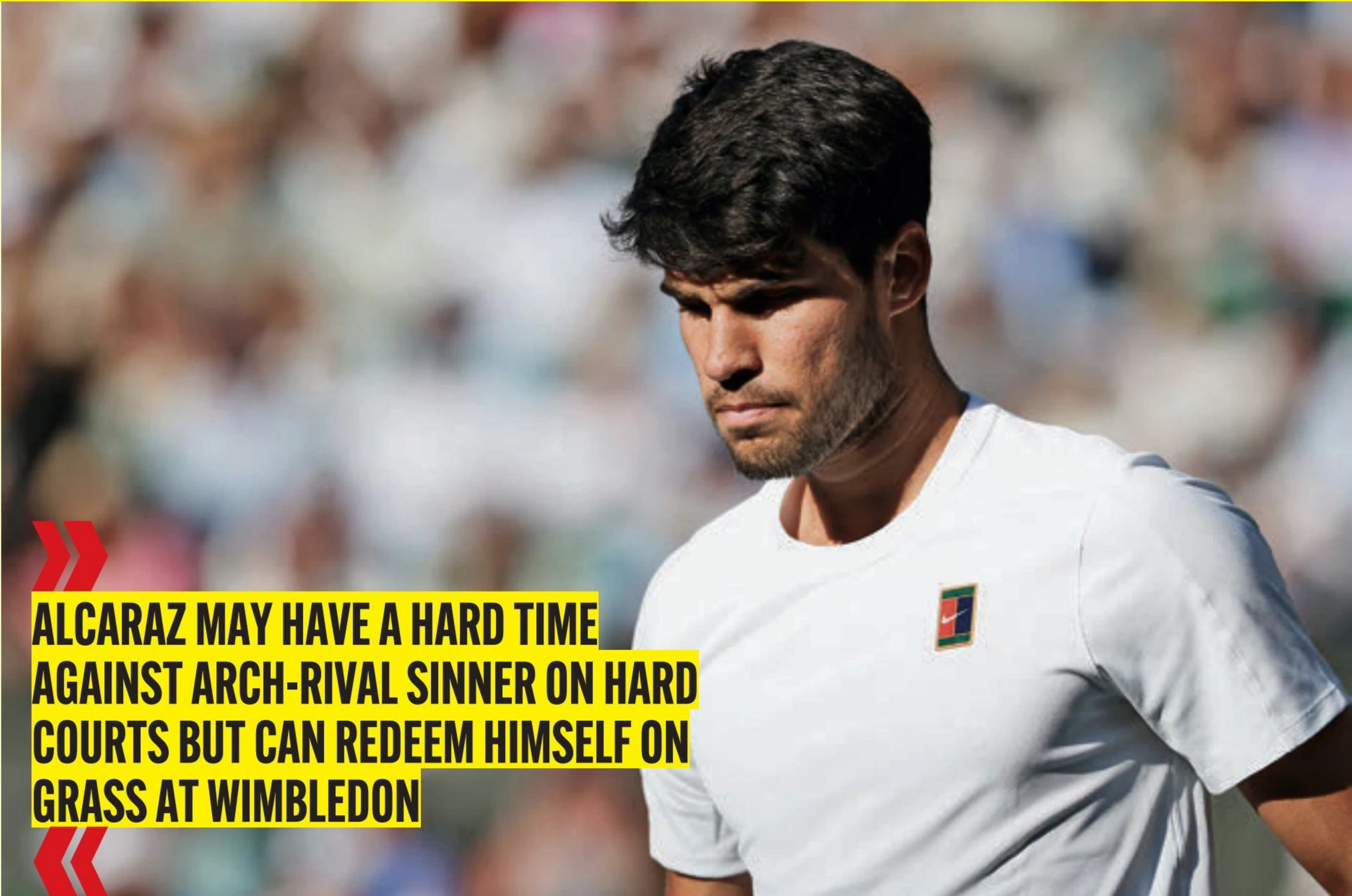




ALCARAZ MAY HAVE A HARD TIME AGAINST ARCH-RIVAL SINNER ON HARD COURTS BUT CAN REDEEM HIMSELF ON GRASS AT WIMBLEDON

have his goal thwarted by arch-rival and defending champion Sinner. Alcaraz will exact revenge at Wimbledon, where he dethrones Sinner.

- **Novak Djokovic** will once again be the sentimental favourite as the tennis GOAT pursues his (seemingly) impossible dream of winning a 25th Grand Slam title. This feat would break his tie with Margaret Court for the all-time all-gender record for most Slam titles.

With specks of grey in his hair but age-defying energy in his lean physique, the 38-year-old Serb made the semifinals at every Major last year. He has acknowledged that beating these young, robust superstars over four or five sets is now a bridge too far. But what if Sinner and Alcaraz get injured or upset?

- **Joao Fonseca**, the most talented and popular South American player since three-time Grand Slam titlist Gustavo 'Guga' Kuerten, will win two Masters 1000 titles and crack the top

10, though the 19-year-old Brazilian won't make a Major final. Fonseca's fervent fans will have to wait until next year for him to break the Big Two's stranglehold on Grand Slam titles.

- **Felix Auger-Aliassime** shares the same birthday as Roger Federer, his boyhood idol, but nowhere near Fed's success. The late-blooming Canadian, now 25, finished 2025 with a bang, making the semifinals at the U.S. Open and ATP Finals and the final at the Paris Masters, while winning Brussels. On rising to a career-high No. 5, the recently married FAA declared, '[I feel] back where I belong... since I was a kid, my ambition was to win Grand Slams and be No. 1 in the world.' Brimming with confidence, Auger-Aliassime will advance to at least one Major semifinal this year and stay in the top five.

- Andy Roddick was the last American man to win a Grand Slam singles title at the 2003 US Open. This long

